

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Refund Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Department	Finance Operations
Company	Aether Wireless
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Overview

This policy outlines Aether Wireless's procedures for processing refunds related to canceled lines and returned devices. It establishes clear timeframes, conditions, and financial adjustments that apply to customer refunds, ensuring consistent and fair treatment across all refund scenarios.

Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all Aether Wireless customers requesting refunds for:

- Canceled wireless lines within the 14-day cooling-off period
- Returned devices and equipment
- Account closures and service terminations
- Device financing and installment plan cancellations

14-Day Cooling-Off Period for New Lines

Eligibility Criteria

- New lines activated within the last 14 calendar days
- Customer must not have exceeded 50% of the plan's included minutes, texts, or data
- Account must be in good standing with no past due balances
- Line must not have been used for international roaming or long-distance calls exceeding \$50

Activation Fee Refunds

- Full activation fee (\$45 standard) refunded when entire line is canceled within 14-day window
- Partial refunds not available for early line cancellations
- Activation fees for additional lines on the same account are non-refundable if other lines remain active

Refund Processing Timeframes

Standard Processing

Refund Type	Processing Time	Delivery Method
Credit/Debit Cards	7-10 business days	Original payment method
Bank ACH	7-10 business days	Original payment method
Cash Payments	7-10 business days	Check by mail
Device Financing	10-15 business days	Account credit or check

Expedited Processing

- Priority processing available for DOA devices (2-3 business days)
- Corporate accounts may qualify for 5-7 business day processing
- International customers: 15-20 business days due to banking requirements

Financial Adjustments and Deductions

Plan Charges

- Monthly service charges prorated based on days of service used
- Unused portion of monthly plan fees refunded
- Regulatory fees and taxes refunded proportionally
- International roaming charges are non-refundable

Device Payments

- All device installment payments refunded in full
- Early termination fees waived for devices returned within 14 days
- Device protection plan premiums refunded proportionally
- Trade-in credits reversed if device is returned

Promotional Credits

- All promotional credits and bill credits clawed back
- Sign-up bonuses and account credits removed from final bill
- Loyalty rewards and points programs adjusted accordingly
- Third-party promotional offers subject to partner terms

Restocking Fees and Conditions

Standard Restocking Fee

- \$35 restocking fee applies to all returned devices
- Fee deducted from refund amount
- Applies to opened boxes and activated devices
- Non-negotiable for customer-initiated returns

Fee Waivers

Restocking fee waived for:

- Dead-on-arrival (DOA) devices within 14 days of delivery
- Manufacturer defects confirmed by technical support
- Devices returned in unopened, factory-sealed packaging
- Devices with critical functionality failures within 30 days

DOA Device Processing

- Immediate replacement or refund required
- Technical support must verify device failure
- Customer must provide proof of purchase and delivery
- Return shipping provided at no charge

Device Financing and Installment Plans

Early Termination

- All remaining device payments forgiven
- Account balance cleared upon device return
- No early termination fees for qualified returns
- Financing agreement terminated without penalty

Account Status Requirements

- Account must be current with no past due amounts
- All associated lines must be in good standing
- No suspended services due to non-payment
- Device must not be reported lost or stolen

Refund Distribution

- Device payments refunded to original payment method
- Down payments refunded in full
- Trade-in values reversed and device value restored
- Manufacturer rebates clawed back if applicable

Non-Refundable Items

Gift Cards and Prepaid Services

- Gift cards and airtime cards are non-refundable
- Prepaid service plans cannot be refunded
- Promotional gift cards excluded from refund policy
- Third-party prepaid cards subject to issuer terms

Additional Non-Refundable Items

- SIM card replacement fees
- International roaming packages
- Device insurance premiums after 30-day period
- Custom ringtones and digital content
- Accessory items older than 30 days

Return Process and Requirements

Required Documentation

- Original proof of purchase or order confirmation
- Valid government-issued photo identification
- Account holder authorization for third-party returns
- Return merchandise authorization (RMA) number

Device Condition Standards

- Normal wear and tear acceptable
- Physical damage voids warranty and return eligibility
- Software modifications may result in restocking fee
- Original packaging and accessories required for full refund

Return Shipping

- Customer responsible for return shipping unless DOA
- Insured shipping recommended for devices over \$500
- Tracking information required for all returns
- Aether Wireless not liable for lost return shipments

Special Circumstances

Corporate Accounts

- Corporate account refunds require authorized signatory approval
- Volume discounts and special pricing may affect refund calculations
- Business equipment leases subject to separate terms
- Tax-exempt status must be verified for refund processing

Family Plans

- Primary account holder authorization required for all line cancellations
- Individual line cancellations affect family plan pricing
- Shared device financing requires all parties' consent
- Account credits distributed proportionally among active lines

International Customers

- Refunds subject to currency exchange rates at time of processing
- International wire transfer fees may apply
- Extended processing timeframes due to banking requirements
- Local tax regulations may affect refund amounts

Dispute Resolution

Internal Review Process

- Customers may request refund review within 30 days
- Finance Operations team reviews disputed cases
- Decision provided within 10 business days
- Management approval required for refunds over \$500

Escalation Procedures

- Customer care supervisors handle initial refund disputes
- Finance managers review complex cases
- Executive review available for amounts exceeding \$1,000
- Legal review required for potential fraud cases

FAQs

Q: Can I get a refund if I cancel my line after the 14-day window?

A: No, the 14-day cooling-off period is mandatory. After this period, only device-related refunds may be available if the device is returned within 30 days, subject to restocking fees and condition requirements.

Q: What happens to my promotional credits if I cancel within the 14-day period?

A: All promotional credits, bill credits, and sign-up bonuses will be clawed back from your final bill. You will only receive refunds for actual payments made, minus any applicable fees and prorated charges.

Q: How is my device financing handled if I return the device?

A: All remaining device installment payments are forgiven, and any payments made toward the device are refunded to your original payment method. The financing agreement is terminated without early termination fees.

Q: Are gift cards refundable if I change my mind?

A: No, gift cards and prepaid airtime are non-refundable under all circumstances. This includes promotional gift cards and third-party prepaid cards, which are subject to the original issuer's terms and conditions.

Q: What qualifies as a dead-on-arrival (DOA) device?

A: A DOA device is one that fails to power on or perform basic functions when first unpacked and activated, provided the failure is not due to customer misuse. Technical support must verify the failure, and the device must be returned within 14 days of delivery.

Q: Can I get a refund for international roaming charges if I cancel my service?

A: No, international roaming charges and international service fees are non-refundable regardless of when you cancel your service. These charges are considered usage-based and apply immediately upon service activation.